

CONFIDENTIAL

723 Squadron,
R.A.N. Air Station,
Nowra, 6C,
N.S.W.
2nd September, 1954.

Sir,

INCIDENT ON NIGHT CROSS COUNTRY AT 1900K
31st AUGUST, 1954.

I have the honour to submit the following report concerning an incident which occurred on 31st August during a night cross country flight from R.A.N. Air Station, Nowra.

2. The route was Nowra - Young - Temora - Yass - Nowra, and the briefed height 13,000 feet.

3. At 1858 I made the following position report to Civil Air Radio Canberra, "Ausnav 921 contact Yass at 13,000 feet estimating Nowra at 1920". This was acknowledged by Canberra, and, when South West of Goulburn, I changed over to 143.64 m/cs, 723 Squadron exercise frequency, and contacted Nowra.

4. After contacting Nowra at approximately 1910, I noticed a very bright light closing fast from "One o'clock". This bright light crossed ahead of me and continued to a position on my port beam where it appeared to orbit. At the same time I noticed a second and similar light at "Nine o'clock", which made a pass about a mile ahead of me and then turned in the position where the first light was sighted.

5. I contacted Nowra and asked if they had me on radar, hoping they would confirm that other aircraft were in the vicinity. They replied that they had 3 echoes and advised me to turn 180° (Course), to be identified if I required a homing. At this stage the two bright lights reformed at "Nine o'clock", from me and disappeared on a North Easterly heading.

6. I saw no other lights and was only able to make out a vague shape with the white light situated centrally on top. Their apparent crossing speed was the fastest that I have ever experienced, and at the time I was indicating 220 knots.

I have the honour to be,

Sir,

Your obedient servant,

J. O'Farrell
.....
J.A. O'FARRELL
LIEUTENANT R.A.N.

The Captain,
R.A.N. Air Station,
Nowra, 6C,
N.S.W.

Enclosure: Statement by Petty Officer (R.P.I.) JESSOP.

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At 1907 aircraft 921 called up and asked if we had him on radar. After checking G.C.I. remote display, we found that two paints appeared on the display approximately 280 degrees 32 miles. After about 15 seconds another paint appeared in the same vicinity. One appeared to be tracking towards base, the others in a North Easterly direction.

About two minutes later we told 921 to fly 180 degrees if he wanted a bearing, so we could identify him. His reply was "Negative", so we did not track the paints any further.

Signed. K.E. JESSOP.
Petty Officer R.P.I.



KDG/RF

605/17G/17.

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UNIDENTIFIED OBJECTS.

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5. OCT 1954

D. A. F. I.

The attached reports, forwarded by the Commanding Officer, R.A.N. Air Station, Nowra, are passed for information.

2. Investigation by this Division has shown that:

- (i) Lieutenant O'Farrell is an entirely credible witness.
- (ii) Witness saw a mass associated with the lights, but was unable to distinguish any form.
- (iii) It was a clear starlit night with no moon.
- (iv) Witness was visibly "shaken" by his experience, but remains adamant that he saw these objects.
- (v) There was no question of collusion between the two witnesses.
- (vi) There were no Naval or Air Force aircraft in the area at the time, but there was a T.A.A. Convair at 14,000 feet on a Northerly course.

D. N. I.
1st October 1954.

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DEPT. OF NAVY
3079/101/1

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Naval Intelligence Division,

1st October 1954.

CONFIDENTIAL.

Commanding Officer,
R.A.N. Air Station,
NOWRA, N.S.W.

UNIDENTIFIED OBJECTS.

Your letter 281/1 of 6th September, together with enclosures, was forwarded on to me by Captain (Air).

2. It is advised that the reports have been passed to the Committee which has been sent up to consider such reports. The Committee desires to express its thanks for such a well authenticated sighting.


J. McL. Adams)
Captain,

Director of Naval Intelligence.

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